



THE DIFFUSION CURVE & DISCIPLESHIP STRATEGY

Sowing Selectively · Discipling Faithfully

Uniting · Serving · Mentoring · Counseling

"As iron sharpens iron, so a man sharpens the countenance of his friend." — Proverbs 27:17

Preach broadly. Disciple selectively.

Rogers' *Diffusion of Innovations* curve segments any population into five tiers: Innovators (2.5%), Early Adopters (13.5%), Early Majority (34%), Late Majority (34%), and Laggards (16%). Most efforts die in the gap Geoffrey Moore named *the chasm*—between visionary early adopters and pragmatic early majority.

Applied to men's discipleship, the model exposes a costly error: trying to market a hard-edged program to *everyone* forces dilution that loses the ready and never reaches the resistant. Scripture already endorses selective investment: Jesus preached to thousands but disciplined twelve.

THE FRAMEWORK

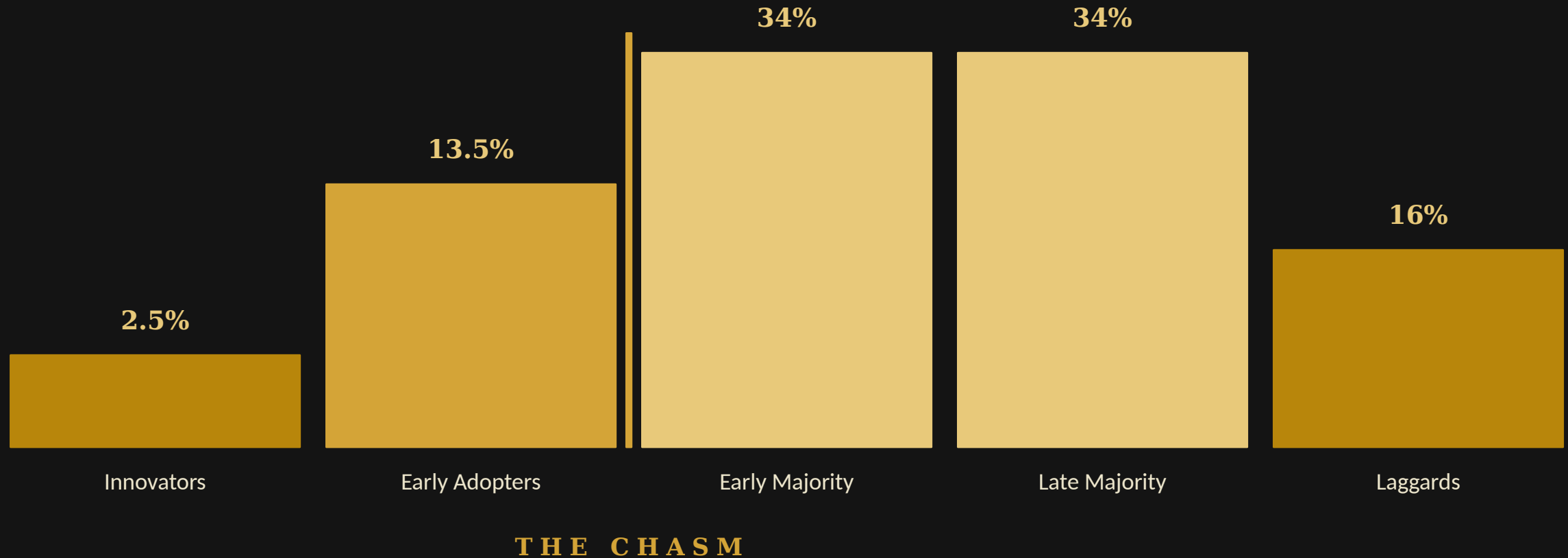
Rogers’ Diffusion Curve · Five Adoption Segments

Segment	%	Mainstream Posture	Ministry Analog
Innovators	2.5%	Build it. Tolerate breakage.	Men already broken & seeking. Join unproven groups.
Early Adopters	13.5%	Visionaries. Adopt for strategic advantage.	Future small-group leaders. Multipliers.
Early Majority	34%	Pragmatists. Need references & proof.	Steady men who join after pastor endorses.
Late Majority	34%	Conservatives. Adopt when not adopting hurts.	Reactive to crisis: divorce, job loss, exposure.
Laggards	16%	Skeptics. Adopt under coercion only.	Hostile or in deep denial.

CROSSING THE CHASM

U.S.M.C. MINISTRIES

Geoffrey Moore's observation: most movements die in the gap between Early Adopters and Early Majority. They never get the references, social proof, and whole-product readiness the pragmatic majority demands.



Selective discipleship is the pattern of Christ and the apostles—not a marketing concession.

Matthew 13:1-23

PARABLE OF THE SOWER

Four soils, four responses, one Sower who keeps sowing while investing depth in the good ground.

2 Timothy 2:2

FAITHFUL MEN

“Commit the things you have heard... to faithful men who will be able to teach others also.” The early-adopter pattern as apostolic strategy.

Luke 10:5-11

SON OF PEACE

Find the receptive house. Where rejected, shake off the dust and move on.
A diffusion filter, not a rejection of the lost.

Matthew 7:6 · Acts 13:46

SOIL DISCERNMENT

Pearls before swine; Paul turning to receptive Gentiles. Evangelism universal. Discipleship selective.

Three operational shifts follow from the framework:

01

Design for the ~15% first.

Programs like the Spotswood Men's Freedom Group, Forsaking All Others, and Proven Men cohorts are calibrated to the innovators and early adopters who are already hungry. Filter language ("for the man who knows he needs to fight") lets the wrong men self-exclude—which is the point.

02

Measure multipliers, not enrollment.

A first cohort's success is the men it equips to lead the next cohort. Volume metrics seduce ministries into softening the edge. The right KPI is faithful men reproducing faithful men—the 2 Timothy 2:2 chain.

03

Evangelism universal. Discipleship selective.

The pulpit is open to every man. The 12-week intensive is not. This is not elitism—it is stewardship of finite hours and Spirit-led timing. The laggard at 35 may be the innovator at 50.

TACC

Temporary Abode for Character Cultivation

Senior Watch Officer

Husband / Father

Senior Administrator

Wife / Mother

Operational Roles

Children with call signs

The framework starts at home.

The TACC family-leadership construct—a MOOP modification of the original framework by John Michael Clark—re-reads the household as the man’s first mission field.

The family captain is the innovator who refuses to wait for the church program, the cultural permission, or the perfect moment. He disciples his wife and children *first*.

If the curve doesn’t cross the threshold of his own front door, no ministry downstream will hold.

THE MINISTRY NETWORK

U.S.M.C. MINISTRIES

No single ministry reaches every segment. Each works a different soil.

Spotswood Baptist Church

ALL FIVE SEGMENTS

Pulpit · pastoral covering · Freedom Group host

spotswood.org

Proven Men Ministries

INNOVATORS · EARLY ADOPTERS

Sexual integrity · 12-week workbook

provenmen.org

Noble Warriors

EARLY ADOPTERS

Retreats · rites of passage

noblewarriors.org

Men of Valor International

EARLY ADOPTER MULTIPLIERS

Global discipleship conferences · 28 countries

menofvalor.org

CBMC

EARLY MAJORITY

Marketplace discipleship · peer groups

cbmc.com

Tun Tavern Fellowship

ACTIVE & PRIOR SERVICE

All-ranks Christian network across the Corps

tuntavernfellowship.org

Selective discipleship is the only sustainable model.

01

Steward Energy

Pouring program hours into resistant soil exhausts leaders and produces little fruit. Matthew 13 already predicts the yield differential.

02

Compound Through Multipliers

Two faithful men reproducing yearly outpace one-time mass enrollment within three cycles. The 2 Timothy 2:2 chain compounds.

03

Protect the Edge

Programs softened for the late majority lose the calling that drew the innovators. The network of ministries distributes the load so no single work has to be all things to all men.

TAKEAWAYS FOR LEADERS

U.S.M.C. MINISTRIES

1

Stop apologizing for a small cohort.

Twelve was Christ's number for a reason.

2

Use filtering language in promotion.

Make the program self-selecting on the front end.

3

Track multipliers, not headcount.

The right KPI is leaders produced per cohort.

4

Distribute the load across the network.

Spotswood, Proven Men, Noble Warriors, Men of Valor, CBMC, and Tun Tavern Fellowship each work a different segment.

5

Disciple your house first, then hold the line.

The family captain leads the first cohort—his own. Then keep the pulpit wide and the cohort narrow.

"And the things that you have heard from me... commit these to faithful men who will be able to teach others also." — 2 Timothy 2:2 (NKJV)